Technical Library - Repository Setup Guideline

Copernicus Land Monitoring Service

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This guide is for the person maintaining a project repository. It is a one-time, administrator-level setup: it links that repository to the CLMS Technical Library, so its documentation can be written, previewed and published alongside the rest of the library.

Editors don't need this page. Once the setup below is in place, they work entirely from the Editor Guidelines.

1. What This Sets Up

Running through this guide integrates an existing project repository with the CLMS Technical Library. The result is:

- a `DOCS/` directory in the project repo, linked to the central library as a git subtree
- a set of Git aliases (`git docs-publish`, `git docs-update`, `git docs-preview`, `git docs-restore`) for day-to-day documentation workflow

Once done, editors can follow the Editor Guidelines to create and publish documents. Your work here is a one-time setup.

2. Prerequisites

For this setup, you only need Git installed and access to the project repository.

Editors will also need the following on their machines - not your responsibility to install, but useful to pass along:

Tool	Purpose	Download
RStudio	Writing and previewing `.qmd` files	posit.co
Quarto	Document rendering engine	quarto.org

Pandoc is bundled with both RStudio and Quarto - editors don't need to install it separately.

3. Integration Steps

Run these commands from the root of the existing project repository.

3.1 1. Add the base documentation repository as a remote

```
git remote add clms-docs-base git@github.com:eea/CLMS_documents_base.git
```

3.2 2. Pull in the `DOCS/` folder as a subtree

```
git subtree add --prefix=DOCS clms-docs-base main --squash
```

This creates the `DOCS/` directory and commits it into the project repository.

3.3 3. Configure the Git aliases

Run the setup script for your operating system:

```
# macOS or Linux
./DOCS/_meta/scripts/linux/setup-docs-aliases.sh

# Windows (PowerShell)
./DOCS/_meta/scripts/win/setup-docs-aliases.ps1
```

This registers four Git aliases for the project:

Alias	What it does
`git docs-update`	Pulls updates from the central base repository into `DOCS/`
`git docs-publish`	Pushes local documentation changes to the Technical Library
`git docs-preview`	Renders the full project locally, including PDF output
`git docs-restore`	Fetches a published version of a document into the local working copy

4. Verify the Setup

> ℹ Note
>
> **TODO:** A verification script is planned for this step. This section will be updated once the script is ready. In the meantime, use the manual checks below as a placeholder.

Confirm the following before handing off to editors:

- ☐ `DOCS/` exists at the project root with `templates/`, `_meta/`, `theme/`, and `includes/` inside
- ☐ `git remote -v` lists `clms-docs-base` as a remote
- ☐ `git docs-publish --help` (or equivalent) responds without an error

5. Handoff Checklist

Before passing to editors, confirm:

- ☐ All three integration steps completed without errors
- ☐ Verification checks above pass
- ☐ Editors have the Editor Guidelines link: Editor Guidelines
- ☐ Editors know they need RStudio and Quarto on their machines (see Prerequisites)

The editors' starting point is the Editor Guidelines. They don't need to touch anything set up here.

6. Change Log

Date	Version	Summary
2026-11-10	1.1.2	Updated introductory text to clarify document purpose and audience. Renamed 'Editor Guide' to 'Editor Guidelines' consistently across text and links.
2026-10-29	1.1.1	Removed obsolete `description` metadata from YAML frontmatter.

Date	Version	Summary
2026-06-03	1.1.0	Added a new 'Setup Guide' document detailing the integration process for existing project repositories with the CLMS Technical Library. This includes instructions for adding the documentation repository as a Git subtree and configuring essential Git aliases for the documentation workflow.